Continuous Research Seminar – 2 (Fall 2026)

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Seminar Details

Title of the seminar	Inter-Agent Transparency in LLM-Based Multi-Agent Systems: A Scoping Review and an Outcome-Aware Influence-Attribution Tool
Category	CPSC Graduate Thesis
Date	29th October 2026
Time	ICT 516
Speaker	Phuong Thao Nguyen (Computer Science MSc Student)
Supervisor	Professor Katie Ovens

Seminar Summary

This research discussed transparency in multi agent systems. The speaker talked about how information is transferred in a system consisting of multiple number of agents, how data is shared, how decisions are made, and how often agents debate with each other. The seminar also discussed the protocols, underlying methods, and various aspects of explainability in the decision-making process of agents. What I liked about the research was the speaker's extensive foundational study of different multi-agent systems. The speaker reviewed 143 existing studies before concluding that many of them did not adequately address transparency in multi-agent systems making it difficult to understand why these systems sometimes hallucinate. The speaker also proposed a scoring mechanism that highlights the transparency of communication between agents in multi-agent systems. This contribution seems to point out important aspects of explainability in multi-agent systems. One area of improvement that I believe is conducting a pilot study to show how making multi agent systems more transparent could improve their performance in real scenarios. I believe that if existing multi agent systems adopted the speaker's approach, this transparency could help identify issues in agent communication and decision making which in turn improves their overall operations.